Education Venture

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Coursera is a for-profit online learning platform that offers a wide range of content and credentials, from courses and specializations to professional certificates and degrees. The company offers these opportunities through partnerships with universities and industry partners (Coursera, 2026). Coursera's main business is in higher education, educational technology, and workforce development. It serves individual learners as well as businesses, governments, and educational institutions (Coursera, 2026). Coursera is a for-profit company and a Delaware public benefit corporation, meaning it also seeks its stated public benefit goals (Coursera, 2026). It is not a tax-exempt nonprofit. The most relevant financial source for evaluating the company is its 2025 Form 10-K, which provides information about its business model, revenue, expenses, and overall financial position (Coursera, 2026).

According to Coursera's recent financial performance, the company is growing but is not yet consistently profitable. Coursera generated $757.5 million in revenue in 2025, increasing from the $694 million it generated in 2024. Consumer revenue generated $502.2 million, a 10% increase from the previous year, while Enterprise revenue generated $255.3 million, a 7% increase from the previous year (Coursera, 2026). Although Coursera reported a $51 million net loss in 2025, this was an improvement from 2024, when it saw a net loss of $79.5 million. Its gross margin increased from 53.5% to 54.6%, while the company generated $108.7 million in operating cash flow (Coursera, 2026). These statistics show that Coursera's financial position is improving, and the company continues to grow, but its net losses put pressure on it to turn that growth into consistent profit.

I believe that a product-market threat is Coursera's greatest AI-related strategic threat. AI isn't exactly reducing the need for people to learn new skills, but it is changing how people can learn them. GenAI tools can be highly personalized to the person they work with. As a result,

they can create personalized practice activities, tests, and other forms of learning support that could compete with Coursera's online course model. A cost-value threat may also arise as consumers question whether Coursera is worth the cost when they can learn new skills using free AI tools. Coursera recognizes this risk in its 2025 Form 10-K. Coursera states that its competitors may incorporate AI into their products quicker and more successfully which could impact the company's ability to compete (Coursera, 2026). However, AI also creates opportunities for Coursera. Enrollments in GenAI courses on the platform grew 195% year over year and surpassed 8 million enrollments, showing that there is a strong demand for learning AI-related skills (Coursera, 2025). This presents an interesting challenge to Coursera because AI is increasing the demand for continuous learning but also creating new ways that people can learn. Coursera will need to give learners a reason to choose its platform over other AI-powered learning tools.

Based on Coursera's current financial position and changes in the education and workforce market, I believe that the company has the ability to continue growing, but it is not a guarantee. Coursera's increasing revenue, decreasing net loss, and stronger operating cash flow show that the company is growing and moving toward a more consistent financial position (Coursera, 2026). Coursera could also benefit from the increasing need for workers to continuously develop new skills as technology continues to transform the workforce. Coursera's Global Skills Report 2025 highlights the growing demand for upskilling, reskilling, and credentials that can help learners demonstrate relevant skills in a changing job market (Coursera, 2025). However, Coursera's future growth will depend on how well it can turn this new interest in online learning into long-term success while staying competitive with new AI-powered learning tools.

Over the next three to five years, I think Coursera should expand and think about what else they can add to the certificates and microcredentials they offer. As AI creates more opportunities for people to learn, simply offering online courses may not be enough to keep learners engaged. Instead, Coursera could focus on providing meaningful experiences and support that AI tools can't easily replicate, helping learners feel more connected. This might include offering trusted ways for learners to showcase their skills to employers, forming partnerships with companies for relevant credentials, and redesigning assessments to better highlight applied knowledge. This approach is supported by the increasing interest in microcredentials and the continuing importance for workers to keep learning new skills as the workforce changes (Coursera, 2025). AI continues to help personalize the learning experience, however, Coursera’s main goal should be to increase the value of its credentials and clearly link them to real job opportunities, helping learners feel more confident and supported in their career paths.

References

Coursera Form 10-K. (2026). In *United States Security and Exchange Commission*. UNITED STATES SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE COMMISSION. https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1651562/000165156226000015/cour-20251231.htm#i336baa2eea424576ad948040bef0c5ea_7

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